

HUGO VACA PEREIRA ROCHA

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Nationality: Bolivian, Brazilian

EMPLOYMENT:

August 2023– Assistant Professor
Department of Economics
University of Wisconsin–La Crosse

EDUCATION:

2023 Ph.D. Economics, Clemson University
2020 M.A. Economics, Clemson University
2017 M.A. Financial Economics, Bowling Green State University
2015 B.A. Economics, University of Arkansas–Fayetteville (*magna cum laude*; minors in Mathematics and Finance)

FIELDS OF INTEREST:

International Economics, Economic Growth and Development, Applied Econometrics

PEER- REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS:

- Vaca Pereira Rocha, H. (2026). "[Convergence Across the Spectrum: R&D Intensity in Manufacturing Growth.](#)" *Journal of Globalization and Development*. doi: 10.1515/jgd-2025-0077
- D'Andrea, F. A. M. C., Vaca Pereira Rocha, H., Jensen, N., Blizard, Z., & Melo, V. (2026). "[Economic Freedom and Rent Seeking: Evidence from US States.](#)" *Public Choice*. doi: 10.1007/s11127-026-01386-6
- Vaca Pereira Rocha, H. (2025). "[Foreign Direct Investment, Structural Change, and Labor Allocation: Comparative Evidence from Asia and Latin America.](#)" *Journal of Economic Integration*. doi: 10.11130/jei.2024050

WORKING PAPERS:

- Melo, V., Vaca Pereira Rocha, H., Sigaud, L., Warren, P. L., & Gaddis, S. M. "[Understanding Discrimination in College Admissions: Experimental Evidence from US Universities.](#)" (*Revise and Resubmit*) at *Journal of Public Economics*.
- Bolivar, O., Canavire-Bacarreza, G., Balthrop, A., & Vaca Pereira Rocha, H. "Hit the Road, Juan: Welfare and Labor Market Effects of High-Quality Roads in Ecuador." (*Revise and Resubmit*) at *Journal of Development Economics*.
- Canavire-Bacarreza, G., de la Flor Giuffra, L., Rodriguez-Castelan, C., & Vaca Pereira Rocha, H. "[Human Capital and the Uneven Geography of Poverty: Evidence from Peru.](#)"
- Vaca Pereira Rocha, H., & Lopez, R. M. "Regional Phillips Curve in a Small Open Economy: Evidence from Bolivia." (*Revise and Resubmit*) at *International Economics and Economic Policy*.

Saavedra-Caballero, F., Nogales, R., & Vaca Pereira Rocha, H. "Accreditation and Labor Market Outcomes in Colombia."

WORK IN PROGRESS:

Jerzmanowski, M., & Vaca Pereira Rocha, H. "Easterners versus Southerners: The EU Integration Process."

TEACHING:

University of Wisconsin–La Crosse:

Intermediate Macroeconomics, Instructor (4 sections)
Money and Banking, Instructor (3 sections)
Principles of Macroeconomics, Instructor (15 sections)

Clemson University:

Money and Banking, Instructor (2 sections)
Principles of Macroeconomics, Instructor (4 sections)
Principles of Macroeconomics, Teaching/Head Teaching Assistant (3 sections)
Principles of Microeconomics, Teaching/Head Teaching Assistant (3 sections)

Bowling Green State University:

Intermediate Microeconomic Theory, Teaching Assistant (1 section)
Principles of Microeconomics, Teaching Assistant (2 sections)
Principles of Macroeconomics, Teaching Assistant (2 sections)
Introduction to Economics, Teaching Assistant (1 section)

University of Arkansas–Fayetteville:

Principles of Macroeconomics, Supplemental Instruction Leader (1 section)
Basic Economics, Supplemental Instruction Leader (2 sections)

HONORS, GRANTS AND AWARDS:

2020–2023	Dr. Robert E. McCormick '72 Annual Fellowship, Clemson University
2021	Best Third Year Paper Award, Clemson University
2020	Best Second Year Paper Award, Clemson University
2014–2015	Honors College Research Grant Award, University of Arkansas–Fayetteville

PRESENTATIONS:

2026	University of Wisconsin–La Crosse, Southern Economic Association, Bolivian Conference in Development Economics*
2025	West Virginia University*, Public Choice Society Meetings, Southern Economic Association
2024	Wofford College*, Carolina Region Empirical Economics Day*, University of South Florida*, University of Oklahoma*, Southern Economic Association, Clemson University*, University of Georgia*
2023	University of Wisconsin–La Crosse, Clemson Macroeconomics Workshop, Clemson Applied Theory Reading Group, Midwest Macroeconomics Meetings, Southern Economic Association
2022	Clemson Macroeconomics Workshop, Western Economic International Association, Clemson Applied Theory Reading Group, Southern Economic Association
2021	Clemson Macroeconomics Workshop, International Atlantic Economic Society, Southern Economic Association
2020	Clemson Macroeconomics Workshop

* Presentations by coauthors.

UNIVERSITY SERVICE:

Curriculum and Assessment Committee, Department of Economics, University of Wisconsin–La Crosse, 2025–
Hiring Committee, Applied Microeconomics Tenure-Track Positions, Department of Economics, University of
Wisconsin–La Crosse, 2024–2025
International Education Committee, University of Wisconsin–La Crosse, 2024–
Merit Review Committee, Department of Economics, University of Wisconsin–La Crosse, 2024–
Scholarship Committee, Department of Economics, University of Wisconsin–La Crosse, 2023–2025
Undergraduate Student Advisor, University of Wisconsin–La Crosse, 2023–
Graduate Student Senator, Bowling Green State University, 2017
Student Union Advisory Committee, Bowling Green State University, 2017

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE:

Referee service: *Economic Analysis and Policy*; *International Advances in Economic Research*.

RESEARCH ASSISTANT POSITIONS:

Spring 2019 Research Assistant to Prof. Howard Bodenhorn, Clemson University
Summer 2014 Research Assistant Intern, Inter-American Development Bank, La Paz, Bolivia

ADDITIONAL TRAINING:

Heterogeneous Agents in Asset Pricing Summer School, Cleveland State University, Summer 2025
Tollison Teaching Workshop with Gail Hoyt, Clemson University, Fall 2021

OP-EDS:

“[La institucionalidad está al lado](#)” (in Spanish), *El Deber*, August 17, 2026.
“[¿Flotar o no flotar?](#)” (in Spanish), *El Deber*, July 29, 2026.
“Ni gasolinazo ni cuento: ¿qué trae el DS 5503?” (in Spanish), *El Deber*, December 24, 2025.
“[¿Bolivia necesita al FMI?](#)” (in Spanish), *El Deber*, October 14, 2025.
“[Del 1985 al 2025: tropezando con la misma piedra](#)” (in Spanish), *El Deber*, August 24, 2025.
“Fiscalidad de urgencia y fiscalidad de futuro” (in Spanish), *El Deber*, July 17, 2025.
“Cambiar de marcha sin derrapar” (in Spanish), *El Deber*, June 26, 2025.
“[Ajustar o colapsar: tres rutas para Bolivia](#)” (in Spanish), *El Deber*, May 27, 2025.
“[¿Modelo Económico o Coñichi?](#)” (in Spanish), *El Deber*, December 29, 2024.
“[La Desagradable Aritmética Monetaria y el Proceso de Cambio](#)” (in Spanish), *El Deber*, December 13, 2024.

MEDIA APPEARANCES:

“[Grocery prices slightly down, but war in Iran could change that](#),” *WKOW 27 News*, April 10, 2026.
“[Rising diesel prices could mean price increases on everyday items](#),” *WKOW 27 News*, March 9, 2026.
“[Rising jet fuel costs in Wisconsin may increase airfares](#),” *WKOW 27 News*, March 6, 2026.
“[Tariffs set in at midnight](#),” *WKBT News 8 Now*, March 3, 2025.

SKILLS:

Programming: Stata, R, Python, Matlab, EViews
Software: $\text{\LaTeX}$, Microsoft Office Suite
AI Tools: Claude/ChatGPT Agents (Codex)

LANGUAGES:

Spanish (Native), Portuguese (Native), English (Fluent)